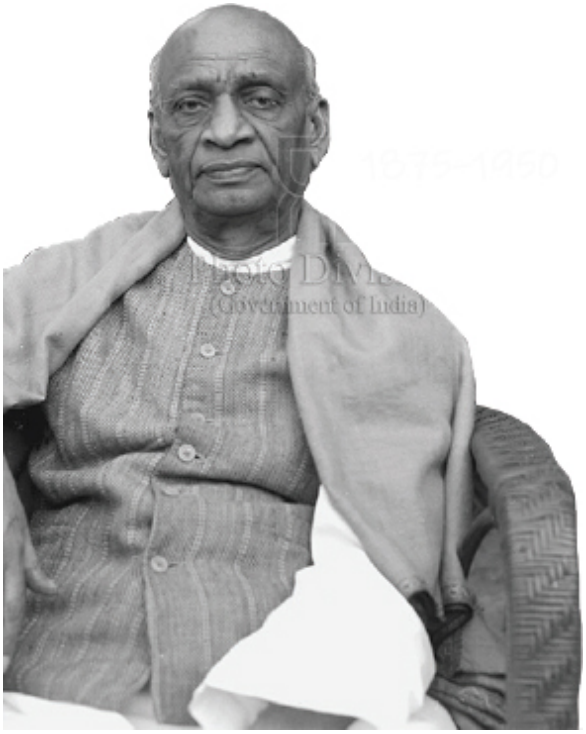
VALLABHBHAI PATEL

1875–1950



The young Vallabhbhai

Patel was one of six children of Jhaverbhai Patel and his wife Ladba. Unable to afford a university education, young Vallabhbhai relied on borrowed books and hard work to qualify as a District Pleader just two years after finishing school (a pleader was a very basic type of lawyer). At thirty-six, he travelled to England, after having saved enough to fulfil his dream of becoming a barrister. Upon his return, Patel, now an English-speaking man in European attire, focused his energies on raising his two young children, and building a reputation as a successful lawyer.

“FOR UNITY, WE MUST FORGET DIFFERENCES OF CASTE AND CREED AND REMEMBER THAT WE ARE